



We have all suffered from the scourge of procrastination at one time or another.

It is problematic because it can cause a great deal of stress if not tackled. It usually results from one of the following areas:

1. Fear of falling short.
2. Not knowing the best way to start.
3. Finding the task boring or unpleasant.

Here are some exercises for dealing with each:

Fear of falling short

- 1.** Imagine for a moment that you could outsource the completion of the project to a friend, write down a list of the tasks that need to be completed from A-Z.

Then, identify the next three smallest possible actions which they can take to get the ball rolling. Psychological distance of imagining your friend having to carry out the task has tricked you into the most important step – an action plan.

Task 1	Task 4	Task 7
Task 2	Task 5	Task 8
Task 3	Task 6	Task 9

- 2.** Don't let a drive for perfection stop you from getting started. If you have to do an entry application essay, remember that your first attempt is only meant to be a crappy first draft from which you can begin to work off.

"You don't have to be great to start, but you have to start to be great", a good quote from Zig Ziglar to remember.

- 3.** Remember the end goal e.g. imagine yourself completing the marathon or celebrating on graduation day. This will help you fuel your efforts in the long run by sticking to the process goals and activities that you need to hit.





Not knowing the best way to start

1. If you have a project and feel like you don't have adequate information to get started and thus like you have no clue what to do then you need to ask yourself, "is there an exemplar in this field whose work I can study and reverse engineer?"

Exemplar _____

Exemplar _____

Exemplar _____

2. Then, ask yourself: could I ask a coach, teacher, colleague or friend to help me with this or put me in contact with somebody who can?

3. What is the smallest possible action you can take right now to get started?





Finding the task boring or unpleasant

- 1.** Is there an activity which I can match the task with to make it not feel so tedious? An example could be running on the treadmill while watching my favourite TV show.

Activity 1 _____

Activity 2 _____

Activity 3 _____

Activity 4 _____

- 2.** Could I make a public commitment towards completing the task and then thrive on the social encouragement and pressure that comes from that?

- 3.** Would it be a good idea to ask a friend to join me to make me less likely to complete it and have more fun in the process e.g. bringing your car in for its annual service or doing a gym class with them?

- 4.** What rewarding activity could I treat myself with once I have completed my tax returns? Maybe a coffee and scone...

Possible reward _____

Possible reward _____

Possible reward _____

Possible reward _____

